



Re-enacting escape from East Berlin, Inge Lange lies strapped beneath car as fiancé Wolfgang Eulitz looks down from window.

A BERLIN LOVE STORY

DUBLIN, EIRE.

FOR FIVE TERROR-FILLED HOURS on a recent foggy night in East Berlin, a blonde, 17-year-old German girl clung desperately to the underside of a speeding car as her fiancé drove toward the Berlin wall and freedom.

Five times they were halted. Jack-booted Communist police poked machine-gun snouts into the car and behind the seats, their feet only inches from the face of the frightened girl strapped to the mud-spattered chassis below.

Today the girl, Inge Lange, is still recovering from that night's ordeal. In a one-room flat here in Dublin she and her fiancé—Wolfgang Eulitz, 22, the man who faced imprisonment and death to bring her out of East Germany—told *PARADE* the story of their flight.

Inge and Wolfgang had fallen in love in East Berlin in the days before the wall. Wolfgang was a music student there. When he accepted a job with an orchestra in Dublin, he promised Inge that as soon as he could save enough money, she would join him and they would be married.

"I went to Dublin," Wolfgang recalls with a shudder, "and there one day I saw a headline. They had built a wall across Berlin—a wall between Inge and me. I knew at once I had to get her out."

He set off across Europe in his little Skoda automobile, driving day and night until he reached Berlin. With his West German passport, he had no trouble passing through the wall and reaching Inge's home. Getting her out would be another matter.

"I was terribly happy that day," Inge recalls, "but after he left I cried. I was afraid we might be killed trying to escape."



Safe at last, Wolfgang and Inge exchange smiles.

Wolfgang soon worked out a daring plan. He would strap Inge to the bottom of his car and smuggle her through the checkpoints under the guards' noses. The risk would be great—but it was the only chance they had.

In the Western sector, where he was staying, Wolfgang ordered special straps, fitted them to the car and—using his brother as a guinea pig—made test runs until he was sure Inge would not be scraped or bumped against the road.

Finally, one foggy, drizzling night, all was ready.

Inge changed into old clothes and descended to the empty street with Wolfgang. Rapidly he fastened the straps, kissed her for luck, then turned to roll out from under the car—and got the shock of his life. There, towering over him in the fog, he recognized the gray uniform and black leather boots of a Vopo—a Communist police guard.

"Anything wrong?" the policeman asked.

"The brake lever needed adjusting," Wolfgang lied.

"I'll give you a hand," the guard said.

Wolfgang scrambled to his feet. "It's okay now," he said hastily. After a pause, the Vopo nodded cheerlessly and stamped away into the fog.

Search at the Wall

An hour later they arrived at the border and were halted at the first of five checkpoints. Wolfgang lit a shaking cigarette as the grim Vopos began their rigorous inspection. *From the corner of his eye, he could see Inge's long hair hanging down under the car. He held his breath.*

In the glare of huge arc lights, two guards pulled out the seats, opened the trunk, even searched under the hood. A third watched, his forefinger curled around the trigger of a submachine gun.

Then, suddenly, it was over. The guards waved Wolfgang on from the last checkpoint. As he passed through the gray concrete wall, spirits soaring, he stamped happily five times on the floor—the prearranged signal of success. Moments later, he was tearing at the straps, freeing Inge, kissing her sobbing, dirt-streaked face. Their ride to freedom was over.

—ROBERT CAMPBELL